Zeros in decimals: placeholder or equal value?

I can... explain the job of zero in a decimal.

Decimal	Read it
0.5	5 tenths
0.50	50 hundredths
0.05	5 hundredths
0.005	5 thousandths

0.5 = 0.50 = 0.500

Ending zeros can rename the same amount in smaller units.

0.5 > 0.05 > 0.005

A zero before the 5 puts it in a different place. Read the unit before comparing.